Trustle

Where to run the Trustle ads

A ranked plan for six vertical video ads aimed at homeowners and landlords in London and Essex, with costs, which ad goes where, and a four-week test.

THE SHORT ANSWER

1. **Pay for Facebook and Instagram first.** Target a radius around your London and Essex postcodes. Your 9:16 ads fit Reels and Stories as they are.
2. **Run Nextdoor alongside it.** It reaches about 1 in 3 London households and skews to homeowners, which is exactly your customer.
3. **Post to TikTok and local Facebook groups for free.** Use TikTok mainly to sign up tradespeople.
4. **Add Google Search later**, for the photo-advice feature, once you have a landing page on your own domain.

Start with about £420 for four weeks. Buy trustle.co.uk before spending anything: an ad pointing to squared-chi.vercel.app looks untrustworthy and will convert worse.

CHANNELS, RANKED

Where your customers actually are

1 Facebook + Instagram (Meta ads)

START HERE · PAID

WHO	Homeowners and landlords aged roughly 30–65, the core of Facebook in the UK. Instagram adds the younger end.
COST	Trades and construction average £0.80–£1.80 per click and £9–£15 per 1,000 views. UK ad spend also carries a 2% Digital Services Tax surcharge.
WHY FIRST	Postcode-radius targeting, Reels placement for your vertical videos, and one ads manager for both apps.
RUN	“We’ve all heard it” (the original), “Ask a tradesman”, “Panic price vs real price”.

2 Nextdoor

START HERE · PAID

WHO	1 in 4 UK households and 1 in 3 in London use it. It skews to homeowners, parents and older adults.
COST	Self-serve Ads Manager since December 2025, with a minimum spend of a few pounds. Click optimisation launched in March 2026.
WHY	Neighbours already ask each other “does anyone know a good plumber?” there. Trustle answers that question directly.
RUN	“The specimen card” and “The honest second opinion”. Calm, useful ads suit a neighbourhood feed better than punchy ones.

3 Local Facebook groups

FREE · ORGANIC

WHO	Area groups such as “Romford Residents” or “Walthamstow Community”, where people ask for trade recommendations every day.
HOW	Read each group’s rules first: many ban ads or allow them only on set days. Post as a person with a useful tip and the photo-advice link, not a hard sell.
RUN	“Snap. Know. Decide.” and the specimen ad. They explain a free tool rather than selling a service.

4 TikTok

ORGANIC FIRST · TRADES

WHO	About 24.9 million UK adults. Half are 18–34 and 62% are women. 26% are 45 or older, so homeowners are reachable but not the core.
BEST USE	Signing up tradespeople: younger trades live on TikTok. For customers, post organically and see what travels before paying.
RUN	“Snap. Know. Decide.” (the punchiest), plus a trades-side ad later (“Trades pay 10% only on jobs they complete”).

5 Google Search ads

LATER · NEEDS A LANDING PAGE

WHO	People searching at the exact moment of the problem: “damp patch on ceiling”, “fence leaning”, “dripping tap fix”.
COST	Home services average about £3.80 per click (range £1.50–£8). Damp-proofing terms run £2–£6. London adds 20–40%.
WHY LATER	Search ads are text, so your videos don’t apply. You need a page on your own domain that goes straight to photo advice.

6 YouTube Shorts

LATER

WHY LATER	Your 9:16 ads will play there, but targeting by local area is weaker than on Meta or Nextdoor. Upload the videos to a channel for free anyway, as a home for them.

COSTS AT A GLANCE

What the numbers say

CHANNEL	TYPICAL COST	REACH	BEST FOR
Facebook + Instagram	£0.80–£1.80 / click £9–£15 / 1,000 views	Most UK adults; postcode radius	Customers, all six ads
Nextdoor	From a few £ / day	1 in 3 London households	Homeowners, landlords
Facebook groups	Free	Per group	Advice-tool posts
TikTok	Free organic	24.9M UK adults, mostly under 35	Signing up trades
Google Search	£2–£8 / click (+20–40% in London)	People searching the problem	Photo advice, later

These are 2026 industry averages from UK marketing sources (listed at the bottom), not quotes

These are 2026 industry averages from UK marketing sources (listed at the bottom), not quotes. Your own costs will differ, which is what the test below is for.

FOUR-WEEK TEST

Spend about £420, then keep what works

BEFORE WEEK 1

Buy trustle.co.uk. Add the Meta Pixel and tagged links so you can see which ad brought each sign-up. Add music to the ads if you can.

WEEKS 1–2

Meta: £10 a day split across 3 ads. Nextdoor: £5 a day on 2 ads. Post one ad a week to local groups and TikTok.

DAY 14 CHECK

Pause any ad whose cost per sign-up is more than double the best one. Move its budget to the winner.

WEEKS 3–4

Run the winners and try the other three ads in the freed budget. On TikTok, boost only a post that already did well for free.

Meta at £10 a day for 28 days is £280, about 19,000–31,000 views at the averages above. Nextdoor at £5 a day is £140. Total: £420 plus the 2% tax surcharge.

What to measure

- **Cost per sign-up**: the main number for choosing winners.
- **Cost per photo-advice request**: shows whether the advice feature is the hook.
- **Cost per posted job**: the number that matters for revenue, once enough data comes in.